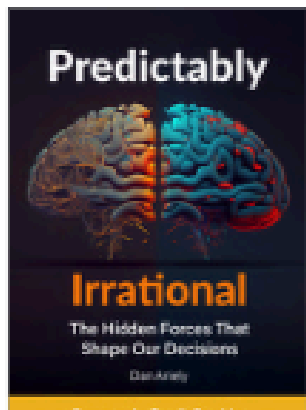




PREDICTABLY IRRATIONAL

The Hidden Forces That Shape Our Decisions

Dan Ariely



The Big “So What”

Why do smart people make bad decisions—again and again? In *Predictably Irrational*, Dan Ariely shows how our choices are shaped by hidden forces we barely notice, from price anchors and social norms to expectations and emotions. Such patterns are systematic and predictable. Once we understand them, we can make smarter decisions in life, business, and policy.



Introduction: Why We Are So Predictably Irrational



We like to think of ourselves as rational beings, especially when the stakes are high. Yet, we make poor decisions all the time.

- Ariely discovered this firsthand as a burn victim, when he saw experienced nurses making systematic errors in pain treatment. This sparked his journey into behavioral economics—a field that blends psychology and economics to study how people *actually* behave, not how they are *supposed* to behave.
- Through more than 20 years of scientific experiments, Ariely studied many factors that influence human behavior. This book reveals why we keep repeating the same mistakes, how to spot those patterns, and design better systems to work around them.
- In this summary, we'll explore Ariely's key insights in 3 parts.

KEY QUOTES

“This book is about human irrationality—about our distance from perfection... recognizing where we depart from the ideal is an important part of the quest to truly understand ourselves.”

“Our irrational behaviors are neither random nor senseless—they are systematic and predictable.”

“Wouldn't economics make a lot more sense if it were based on how people actually behave, instead of how they should behave?”

“Once you see how systematic certain mistakes are—how we repeat them again and again—I think you will begin to learn how to avoid some of them.”

Why We Are So Predictably Irrational



How We Misjudge Value



Relativity Bias



Anchoring Effect



The Danger of "Free"



Expectation Shapes Reality



Placebo Pricing



Ownership Bias



Why We Lack Self-Control



Hot-State Thinking



Self-Control Failure



Too Many Options



When Social Factors Override Rationality



Social vs Market Norms



The Honest Cheat



Context Shapes Integrity



Social Pressure

KEY QUOTES



Part 1: How We Misjudge Value

We assume people know what they want and make rational choices. But in reality, our sense of value is easily distorted—by context, comparisons, and expectations.

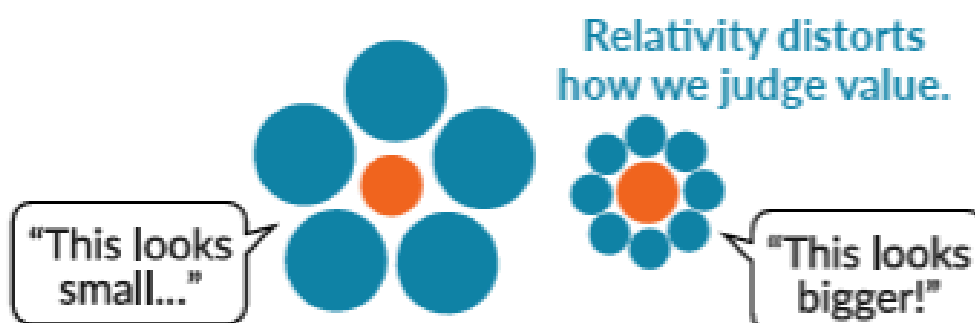


Relativity: We Judge Value in Relative Terms, not Absolutes



We don't judge things in isolation. We rely on comparisons to decide what's "better" or "worth it"—even if those comparisons are arbitrary or misleading. This tendency, called relativity, shapes our decisions and even affect how happy we feel.

"Humans rarely choose things in absolute terms. We don't have an internal value meter that tells us how much things are worth."



- Marketers exploit this with tricks like the "decoy effect", by introducing an inferior option (or a more expensive one) to nudge us toward a specific choice. In a study, participants were given 3 subscription options:

(i) Online-only (\$59)

(ii) Print-only (\$125)

(iii) Print + Online (\$125)

Almost no one picked option (ii), but its presence made the last option (the combo) look like a great deal. When option (ii) was removed, far fewer people chose the combo deal.

- Adding an overpriced item on a restaurant menu makes other expensive dishes seem more reasonable. In travel, people are more likely to choose “Rome with coffee” over “Rome without coffee”—even if they don’t care about the coffee.



Instead of evaluating real trade-offs, we often compare with options that are nearby or easy to compare, even if they’re irrelevant.

- People will choose an inferior option over a superior one just because it looks better than something else. For example:
 - They might choose a job with a higher salary in a worse city because salary is easier to compare than quality of life.
 - A \$10 saving feels more exciting on a \$25 pen than a \$500 suit—even though the value of \$10 is identical.
 - We may pay \$3,000 for a car seat upgrade but balk at \$1,000 for a home sofa that we use more often.



To make better decisions:

- Avoid environments that trigger irrelevant comparisons, like touring homes you can’t afford or comparing yourself to others.
- Think beyond what’s in front of you: focus on what’s truly relevant and important to you.



Anchoring Bias: First Impressions Stick



Our decisions are often shaped by arbitrary anchors. The first price we encounter often leaves an imprint that influences future decisions—even if the anchor is irrelevant.

KEY QUOTES

“Most people don’t know what they want unless they see it in context.”

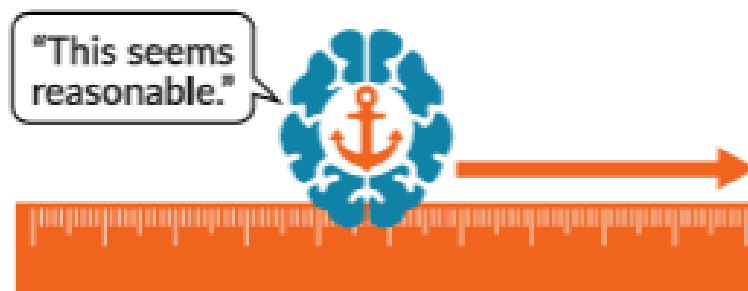
“We are always looking at the things around us in relation to others. We can’t help it.”

“We not only tend to compare things with one another but also tend to focus on comparing things that are easily comparable—and avoid comparing things that cannot be compared easily.”

“Relativity helps us make decisions in life. But it can also make us downright miserable.”

“The more we have, the more we want. And the only cure is to break the cycle of relativity.”

“Our first decisions resonate over a long sequence of decisions.”



KEY QUOTES

- In an experiment, people wrote down the last 2 digits of their Social Security number (SSN), then bid on items like wine or books. Those with higher SSNs consistently bid more—even though these were random digits unrelated to the item.
- Tahitian black pearls had no demand initially. But, after marketers displayed them in high-end jewelry stores among other precious jewels, they became anchored in people's minds as rare and valuable. Demand skyrocketed after that.
- Coffee used to be 50¢. Then, Starbucks came along with Italian names, a cozy setting, and new rituals around coffee. Now, paying \$5 for a coffee seems perfectly normal.
- Anchoring also affects how we value time, pain, or effort. In an experiment, participants were exposed to an irritating noise for 30 seconds, then asked how much they must be paid to hear it again. Those who were first asked "Would you listen to this again for 90¢?" demanded higher compensation than those who were initially asked "Would you listen to this again for 10¢?"

"The random, and not so random, anchors that we encountered along the way and were swayed by remain with us long after the initial decision itself."

"The choices and trades we make are not necessarily going to be an accurate reflection of the real pleasure or utility we derive from those products."

 The perceptions from irrational anchors persist over time, reinforced by imitation and repetition (herding and self-herding).

- When we see a line outside a new café, we assume it must be good so we join in. We follow the herd assuming they know better, and our behavior further reinforces others' behaviors.
- Over time, we also herd ourselves. Once we've paid \$5 for a coffee several times, we keep doing it without evaluating our choice each time.



What can we do about our anchoring bias?

- Be alert to the first price, experience, or label you encounter, as it can shape your future decisions. Ask: Would I make the same choice if I started fresh today?

"Socrates said that the unexamined life is not worth living. Perhaps it's time to inventory the imprints and anchors in our own life."

- In marketing and policies, explore how anchors can be used to (i) promote savings and healthy choices, or to (ii) protect people from manipulative price cues.



Zero Price Effect: Free Things Come at a Cost



We overvalue free things, even though they often cost us more in time, effort, or missed opportunity.

- The word "FREE!" triggers a strong emotional response. We grab free items we don't need, because they appear to be risk-free. The "zero price effect" refers to how we irrationally choose inferior products or waste time/effort just because something is free.



- In a study, when participants were presented with a high-quality Lindt truffle over a standard Hershey's Kiss (Scenario A), most chose the Lindt. Yet, when the Kiss was offered for free (Scenario B), most chose the Kiss—despite an identical price difference:

Scenario A	Scenario B
Lindt Truffle: 15¢ Hershey's Kiss: 1¢	Lindt Truffle: 14¢ Hershey's Kiss: FREE
73% chose the Truffle	69% chose the Kiss

- In another study: kids could choose between (i) a large Snickers bar in exchange for 1 Kiss, or (ii) a smaller bar for free. Most chose the free version even though it was the worse option. Adults also prefer offers that include free items, even if they're worse deals overall.
- Amazon saw a huge boost in sales when they offered free shipping—except in France, where the fee was a negligible 1 franc (about 20¢). When France switched to free shipping, their sales jumped too.
- A zero-calorie drink sells much better than a 1-calorie one—even though the difference is insignificant.

KEY QUOTES

"Zero is not just another price, it turns out. Zero is an emotional hot button—a source of irrational excitement."

"When choosing between two products, we often overreact to the free one."

"We just can't resist the gravitational pull of FREE!"

"The difference between two cents and one cent is small. But the difference between one cent and zero is huge!"

- In reality, zero-price items can cost you more time, effort, and money in the long-term..
 - Ariely bought a costly Audi (instead of an economical, practical minivan) partly because it came with 3 years of free oil changes—worth only about \$150.
 - People queue for hours for free cones or giveaways—paying much more in time/effort than what they save in money.



Beware of hidden costs behind “free” deals.

- As individuals: Ask “Would I still want this if it weren’t free?” Pause before accepting freebies that clutter your space, waste your time, or sway your decisions.
- As businesses/policymakers: Use “Free!” to nudge people toward better choices, e.g. free health screenings, public transport, or eco-options.



Expectations: How Beliefs Can Alter Reality



Our beliefs and expectations shape our reality. Once we form a belief about a product, person, or experience, our mind filters information to match that belief—even if it contradicts the actual facts.

- In an experiment, participants tasted two beers: a regular beer, and another with balsamic vinegar added. Those who weren’t told about the vinegar preferred it over the regular beer. But when they knew beforehand, they rated the vinegar beer much lower. The pre-knowledge had distorted their taste experience.
- Branding and presentation also affect our perceived experiences.
 - In a taste test for Coke vs Pepsi, participants favored Pepsi during the blind test. But when the brands were revealed, people prefer Coke—because the brand triggered stronger emotional and memory-related brain activity.
 - In a study, people were offered condiments (e.g. nutmeg, cloves) with their coffee. When the condiments were presented in upscale containers, people were willing to pay

KEY QUOTES

“When we believe beforehand that something will be good, therefore, it generally will be good—and when we think it will be bad, it will bad.”

“When the coffee ambience looked upscale...the coffee tasted upscale as well.”

much more than when they came in Styrofoam cups—even though the coffee and condiments were identical.



- Stereotypes affect expectations and behaviors too. Before a math test, participants were subtly reminded of either their Asian identity (positive math stereotype) or female identity (negative math stereotype). When primed with their Asian identity, scores went up. When primed with their female identity, scores dropped.



Be aware of how expectations shape your experience, especially when evaluating products, services, or people. You can also use rituals, symbols, or subtle cues to elevate experiences for yourself and others, e.g. using fancy menus, proper plating, and ambience to increase a meal's enjoyment.



Price: Why Expensive Feels More Effective



Placebos have been repeatedly found to alleviate pain, improve performance, and alter physical states. For example, medical placebos (like sugar pills) have been found to reduce pain or symptoms just because patients believe in their effectiveness.

- This response is triggered by a wide range of cues, such as:
 - How a treatment is described (e.g. “fast-acting”);
 - What it costs (e.g. full price vs. discount); and
 - How it's presented (e.g. fancy packaging or brand label).
- Price acts as a powerful trigger for placebo effects. Higher prices lead us to expect higher value and better outcomes, creating real improvements in pain relief, performance, and perception—even when the product itself is exactly the same.



KEY QUOTES

“Expectations can influence nearly every aspect of our life.”

“The truth is that placebos run on the power of suggestion. They are effective because people believe in them.”

“We filter information through our eyes and brains in accordance with our expectations and patterns—and we are very good at convincing ourselves that what we wanted to see is indeed what we saw.”

KEY QUOTES

- In a study, all participants were given a fake painkiller (vitamin C) and exposed to mild electric shocks. Group A was told it costs \$2.50 while Group B was told it costs \$0.10. The expensive version reduced pain more—even though both were fake.
- In another study, participants received an energy drink before attempting to solve puzzles. Those who paid the full price solved more puzzles compared to the discounted group. In a follow-up study, participants were also told that the drink improved mental functioning—the full-price group showed much better performance, while the discounted group didn't.



Placebo effects are real and powerful. The same item can have drastically different effects based on expectations shaped by price, branding, and presentation.

- But when people stop to think more carefully about what's happening, the placebo effect often disappears.
- Ariely reflects on whether placebo effects should be encouraged—especially since higher-priced placebos tend to be more effective. He highlights the ethical dilemma and calls for more research to better understand placebo potential and limits.

"Our expectations can affect us by altering our subjective and even objective experiences—sometimes profoundly so."

"Consumers who stop to reflect about the relationship between price and quality are far less likely to assume that a discounted drink is less effective...the effect of discounts is largely an unconscious reaction to lower prices."



Ownership Bias: We Overvalue What We Own



We tend to overvalue what we own, simply because it's ours. This endowment effect leads us to inflate prices, overbid in auctions, and resist letting go of objects, services, or even beliefs that we've grown attached to.

- Ownership distorts how we see value. In a study at Duke University, students entered a lottery for basketball tickets.
 - Those who won tickets were only willing to sell them for an average of \$2,400, focusing on the experiences and memories they'd lose.
 - Those who didn't win were only willing to pay \$170, focusing on the alternative ways they could use the money.

"We fall in love with what we already have."

"Ownership pervades our lives and, in a strange way, shapes many of the things we do."

- Both groups had equal desire before the draw. The only difference was ownership—which made winners value their tickets far more. Ariely points out 3 quirks:

- (i) Once something is ours—whether a house, a mug, or a sofa—we fall in love with it.
- (ii) We wrongly assume others see the same value in our possessions—but they don't.
- (iii) We fear losing more than we value gaining. So, we demand more to give something up than we'd pay to acquire it.



 Ownership can be physical or virtual.

- The more effort we invest in something, the more we value it. The “IKEA effect” is how we feel more attached to things we help to build, even if the outcome isn't better.
- We may feel virtual ownership without even touching the item. In online auctions, people bid more aggressively the longer they're the top bidder, because they feel the item is already theirs. Free trials and 30-day return policies work the same way—once people try a product, they're reluctant to down-grade or return it.
- We also get attached to our ideas and decisions, making it harder to let go or change course.

 There's no direct way to counter ownership bias. Ariely recommends pausing before buying to ask: Would I value the item the same way if it weren't already mine?



Part 2: Why We Lack Self-Control

We often intend to act in our long-term interests, but give in to temptation. We overvalue short-term rewards, struggle with self-control and change our preferences in the heat of the moment.

KEY QUOTES

“It is just difficult for us to imagine that the person on the other side of the transaction...is not seeing the world as we see it.”

“The more work you put into something, the more ownership you begin to feel for it.”

“Virtual ownership... is one mainspring of the advertising industry.”

“There is no known cure for the ills of ownership...But being aware of it might help.”

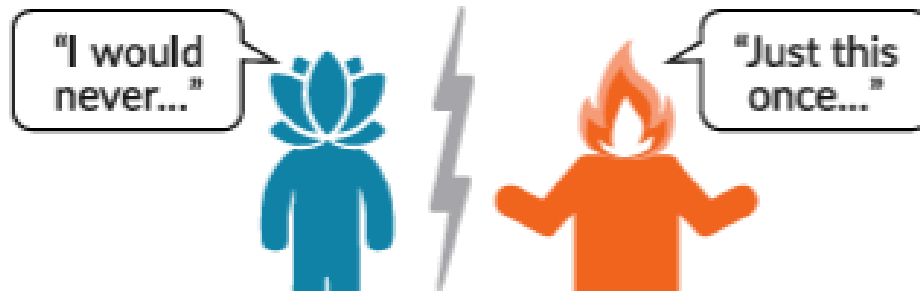
“Even the most brilliant and rational person, in the heat of passion, seems to be absolutely and completely divorced from the person he thought he was.”



Hot-State Thinking: We Act Differently When Aroused



We like to think we can manage our behaviors at all times, but we're surprisingly bad at anticipating how we'll act when emotionally charged. In moments of intense arousal—whether it's lust, anger, or excitement—we make choices we won't endorse in a rational state.



- In an experiment, male college students were asked to answer a set of questions related to sexual behavior: once in a normal, rational state and again while sexually-aroused. In the aroused state, the same individuals were (i) more willing to engage in morally questionable behaviors (e.g. lying, drugging a partner) and (ii) more likely to take sexual risks (e.g. foregoing condoms, engaging in taboo acts).
- Similar patterns emerge with anger, fear, hunger, or even competitiveness. When emotions take over, we become impulsive, take greater risks, rationalize unethical behavior, and become less empathetic.



By understanding the gap between our "cool state" and "hot state" we can design smarter policies and make better choices. Plan ahead for your hot state while you're in cool state.

- Don't rely on willpower. Avoid situations where you'll face temptation, arousal or emotional overload that impair judgment.
- Create structural boundaries or safeguards while you're still rational. For example, keep condoms on hand, use cooling-off periods for purchases, or write scripts for what to do when angry or triggered.

KEY QUOTES

"Looking from one emotional state to another is difficult. It's not always possible; and... it can be painful."

"[The participants] were simply unable to predict the degree to which passion would change them."

"We need to explore the two sides of ourselves...we need to see how the gap between the hot and cold states benefits our lives, and where it leads us astray."

"Avoiding temptation altogether is easier than overcoming it."

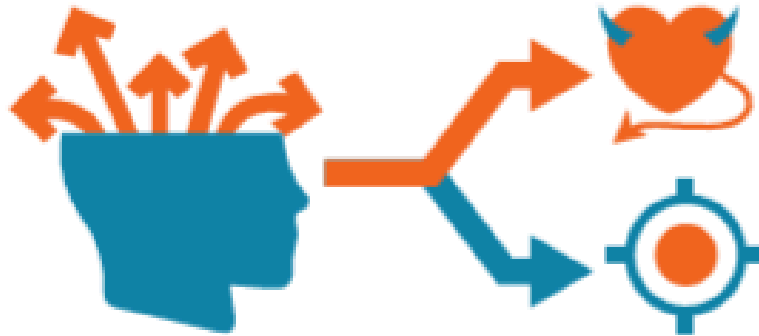
"Perhaps just being aware that we are prone to making the wrong decisions when gripped by intense emotion may help us."



Self-Control Failure: Why We Delay What Matters



Even when we know what's good for us—like saving money, exercising, eating healthy—we often don't do it because we give in to instant gratification.



- Left to own devices, we procrastinate. For instance, in a classroom experiment, students had to submit 3 papers in 12 weeks:
 - (i) Group 1 had fixed deadlines at weeks 4, 8, and 12.
 - (ii) Group 2 chose their own deadlines, with penalties if late.
 - (iii) Group 2 had no deadlines, only a final submission date.

Group 1 performed best, followed by Group 2 (though those who spaced out their deadlines did better than those who bunched them up at the end). Group 3 (with most freedom) did the worst.



We're more likely to succeed when we put up guardrails in advance.

- Design systems that bridge the gap between what we want to do and what we actually do. Use precommitments, e.g. pay a refundable deposit for a medical test so you're less likely to skip your health check, use automatic payroll deductions for savings, or exercise with a buddy to stay accountable.



Too Many Options: Why We Struggle to Let Go



We like to keep all our doors open, even when it makes us worse off. This fear of missing out leads us to juggle too many paths at once, stretch ourselves thin, and delay important decisions.

KEY QUOTES

"Giving up on our long-term goals for immediate gratification, my friends, is procrastination."

"Without precommitments, we keep on falling for temptation."

"People may set deadlines for themselves, but not necessarily the deadlines that are best for getting the best performance."

"We have problems with self-control...But each of the problems we face has potential self-control mechanisms, as well."

- When we try to keep all our options open, we lose focus/energy and hurt results.



- In an experiment, participants played a game where they earned money by clicking on doors in a virtual room. Each click earned cash, but the doors would disappear if ignored for too long. Since players had limited clicks, the best strategy was to focus on the most rewarding door. Yet, many kept clicking on low-paying doors just to stop them from disappearing.
- We make the same mistake in real life. People stay in bad jobs, relationships, or commitments because they don't want to "burn bridges." Or, we overcommit to too many things because we can't bear to let go.
- Given the choice, people will keep too many possibilities alive, fearing they'll miss out or make the wrong decision. This only reduces our ability to pursue the options that truly matter, leading to stress, distraction, decision paralysis, lost opportunities, and diminished results.
- ✳ To focus, we must be willing to close doors—like how Chinese general Xiang Yu burned his army's ships after crossing a river, successfully forcing his troops to fight their way out with full commitment. Accept that you can't pursue everything. Let go of less promising paths to focus on what matters.



Part 3: When Social Factors Override Rationality

We like to think of ourselves as independent thinkers. In reality, our behavior is heavily shaped by social forces—like norms, expectations, and the people around us.

KEY QUOTES

"We work feverishly to keep all of our options open."

"How can we unshackle ourselves from this irrational impulse to chase worthless options?"

"What we need is to consciously start closing some of our doors...We have an irrational compulsion to keep doors open."

"Given a simple setup and a clear goal...all of us are quite adept at pursuing the source of our satisfaction."



Social vs Market Norms: Why Money Changes Relationships



We operate in 2 distinct worlds: one governed by *social norms* like trust, reciprocity, and community, and another governed by *market norms* like pricing, contracts, and transactions. Each works well on its own. But once you mix them, motivation collapses and it's hard to restore the social relationship afterward.



Social rewards can drive higher effort than money.

- People are often more motivated by goodwill than by small payments. In an experiment, participants were asked to drag circles into a square for 5 minutes.
 - (i) Those who did it as a favor (no pay) finished 168 circles.
 - (ii) Those paid \$5 finished 159 circles.
 - (iii) Those paid 50¢ finished 101 circles.



The unpaid group worked hardest, while a small payment undermined effort—as it shifted the mindset from doing a favor to calculating whether the effort was “worth it.”

- The same effect was seen with gifts/rewards. When participants received chocolates as gifts, they worked harder regardless of the value of the chocolate. Once a value was attached to the gift (e.g. “50¢ Snickers”), effort dropped as the relationship became transactional.
- In a study, people who were exposed to words or screensavers about money became more self-reliant, less helpful, and more socially distant. Just thinking about money shifted their behavior toward market norms, even without monetary transactions.
- Once market norms enter, social norms disappear—and they seldom return. For example, a daycare center introduced a fine for parents who picked up their kids late. This actually *increased* the lateness, as parents now saw it as a fee-for-service, not a moral obligation to be on time. When the fine was removed later, lateness remained high as the relationship had changed.

KEY QUOTES

“When we keep social norms and market norms on their separate paths, life hums along pretty well...When social and market norms collide, trouble sets in.”

“People are willing to work free, and they are willing to work for a reasonable wage; but offer them just a small payment and they will walk away.”

“Money, as it turns out, is very often the most expensive way to motivate people. Social norms are not only cheaper, but often more effective as well.”

“Introducing market norms into social exchanges... violates the social norms and hurts the relationships.”

“Life with fewer market norms and more social norms would be more satisfying, creative, fulfilling, and fun.”



Don't mix money with relationships.

- In personal relationships, don't offer money for personal favors or mention prices when it comes to gifts.
- In business, choose a frame and stick to it. If you want employees to focus on purpose and contribution, don't over-rely on cash rewards or penalties. If you're building a social relationship with customers, stick to social norms—even 1 wrong signal can change the relationship.
- Policy-makers should beware of using fines or payments to replace social obligations (e.g. parenting, civic duty) as it can erode intrinsic motivation in the long run.



The Honest Cheat: Why Good People Break Rules



We tend to view dishonesty as a deliberate crime—like a robber weighing the risk of getting caught before stealing. In reality, most cheating comes from well-meaning people who bend the rules slightly—just enough to benefit without feeling like “bad people.”



- We justify “small” infractions like fudging expenses, copying homework, or wearing clothes with tags before returning them. Yet, such minor acts can accumulate into major systemic damage, e.g. employee fraud costs \$600 billion annually—more than all robberies, burglaries, and thefts combined.
- We cheat just enough to benefit, but not enough to feel immoral. In a test, participants were paid for every correct answer. Those who self-reported their scores overstated them slightly. When the answer sheets were shredded (so there seemed to be no accountability), cheating increased but not outrageously.

KEY QUOTES

“If you want a social relationship, go for it, but remember that you have to maintain it under all circumstances.”

“Cheating arises from our attempts to balance two incompatible goals. On one hand, we want to look in the mirror and feel good about ourselves...On the other hand, we're selfish, and we want to benefit from cheating.”

“People cheat when they have a chance to do so, but they don't cheat as much as they could. Moreover, once they begin thinking about honesty...they stop cheating completely.”

“When we are removed from any benchmarks of ethical thought, we tend to stray into dishonesty. But if we are reminded of morality at the moment we are tempted, then we are much more likely to be honest.”



Moral reminders are a powerful deterrent for dishonesty. Just by asking people to recall the Ten Commandments or sign an honor code, you can activate their moral self-concept to dramatically reduce or even eliminate cheating.



Context & Abstraction: Environment Shapes Our Integrity



Context matters. People are more likely to cheat when their actions feel abstract or disconnected from real consequences.

- We're more likely to cheat when money isn't directly involved.
 - In a dorm, six-packs of Coke disappeared quickly from the fridge, while plates with \$1 bills were left untouched.
 - We're more likely to take home a pen from the office than to take \$1 from the petty cash to buy one.
 - When participants were paid in tokens (exchangeable for money) instead of cash, cheating more than doubled.



- This effect extends to real-world corruption, e.g. doctors may accept gifts from pharmaceutical companies (but not bribes), and employees may misreport numbers (instead of stealing cash).



As society moves toward cashless digital systems, it increases our psychological distance from money, making dishonesty more tempting and easier to rationalize. making it easier to rationalize dishonest behavior. To counter this, we need to deliberately connect actions to consequences, e.g. pricing office supplies or requiring pre-signature pledges.



Social Influence: How Others Shape Our Choices



Our personal preferences are often distorted in a group setting.

KEY QUOTES

"Cheating is a lot easier when it's a step removed from money."

"We can be dishonest without thinking of ourselves as dishonest. We can steal while our conscience is apparently fast asleep."

"When we deal with money, we are primed to think about our actions as if we had just signed an honor code."

- In social contexts, we often sacrifice our real preferences and true satisfaction to fit in or to protect our self-image.
- In an experiment, patrons who ordered beer aloud at a pub were less happy with their selections, as they chose options that seemed unique. Those who ordered privately were more satisfied with their choices (as they picked what they really wanted). The person who ordered first was usually the most content, as their choice was undistorted by social influence.



Watch for the impact of social influence and be more intentional with your choices.



Conclusion and Other Details in the Book



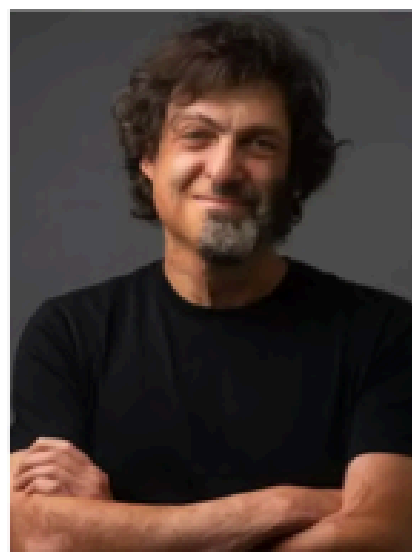
Standard economics assumes we make rational trade-offs. But behavioral economics reveals how our decisions are shaped by hidden forces—like emotion, framing, and social pressure. By understanding these patterns, we can design smarter choices, avoid repeated mistakes, and create subtle nudges that benefit individuals, businesses, and society.



This book includes many other real-world experiments and examples to explain the factors that shape our decisions and behaviors. For more information, visit predictablyirrational.com.



About the Author



Dan Ariely is a leading behavioral economist and professor at Duke University. Known for his engaging research on human irrationality, he explores how emotions, social norms, and cognitive biases influence our decisions. Ariely is also the founder of several behavioral science centers and a bestselling author of books. His work bridges academic insight with practical tools to improve choices in business, health, and everyday life.

KEY QUOTES

"People are sometimes willing to sacrifice the pleasure they get from a particular consumption experience in order to project a certain image to others."

"If we all make systematic mistakes...why not develop new strategies...to improve our overall well-being?"